

Topic #:

Single Source Shortest Path

What is Shortest Path Problem?

=> Shortest path problem is a problem of finding the shortest path(s) between vertices of a given graph.

=> Shortest path between two vertices is a path that has least cost as compared to all other existing paths.

Shortest Path Algorithm:

=> Shortest path algorithms are family of algorithms used for solving the shortest path problem.

Applications:

=> Shortest path algorithms have a wide range of applications such as in-

- o Google Maps
- o Road Networks
- o Logistics Research

Types of Shortest Problem:

- o Single - Pair SPP
- o Single - Source SPP
- o Single - destination SPP
- o All pairs SPP

1) Single-Source Shortest Path Problem:

=> it is a shortest path problem where the shortest path from a given source vertex to all other remaining vertices is computed.

=> Two algorithms used for solving single-source shortest path problem:

- o Dijkstra's
- o Bell-man Ford

Dijkstra's Algorithm:

=> very famous greedy algorithm

=> Compute the shortest path from one particular source node to all other remaining nodes of the graph.

Conditions:

- o works only for connected graph.
- o (works for directed) ^{correctness of this algorithm} as well as undirected graph.
- o The graph edges should be weighted.
- o works only for those graphs that do not contain any negative edge.

$$w(u, v) \geq 0$$

Dijkstra(G, w, s)

Initialize - Single-Source(G, s)

$S = \phi$

$Q = G \cdot V$

while $Q \neq \phi$

$u = \text{Extract-min}(Q)$

$S = S \cup \{u\}$

for each vertex $v \in G \cdot \text{Adj}[u]$

Relax(u, v, w)

Relax(u, v, w)

if $v.d > u.d + w(u, v)$

$v.d = u.d + w(u, v)$

$v.\pi = u$

Initialize - Single-Source(G, s)

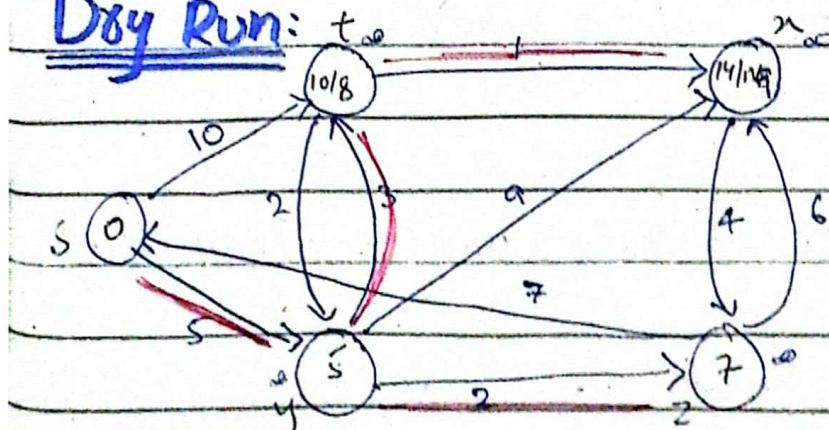
for each vertex $v \in G \cdot V$

$v.d = \infty$

$v.\pi = \text{NIL}$

$s.d = 0$

Dry Run:



Node	distance	π	
S	$\infty / 0$	NILL	$S = \{ \{s\}, \{y\}, \{z\}, \{t\} \}$
t	$\infty / 10 / 8$	NILL / s / y	
x	$\infty / 14 / 13$	NILL / y / z / t	
y	$\infty / 5$	NILL / s	
z	$\infty / 7$	NILL / y	

Time complexity: $O(V + E \cdot \log(V))$
 Total $\approx O(E \log V)$

Applications:

- Used in routing protocols, serviced by the routers to update their forwarding table.
- Provide shortest cost path from the source router to other routers in the network.

Terms:

S = Source vertex

W = weights

Q = Queue (Priority queue to greedily chooses the nearest node)

S = set

Main Advantages:

- Little complexity which is almost linear

Drawbacks:

- unable to handle negative edge

- o There is a need to maintain tracking of vertices, have been visited.
- o Does not produce accurate shortest path to the ^{unweighted} acyclic graph.
- o it does an obscured exploration that consumes a lot of time while processing.

Bellman Ford Algorithm

- => Solve the single source shortest paths problem.
- => In general in the case in which edge weights may be negative.
- => it works by overestimating the length of the path from the starting vertex to all other vertices.
- => Then it iteratively relaxes those estimates by finding new paths that are shorter than the previously overestimated paths.
- => on a given weighted directed graph $G = (V, E)$ with source s and weight function $w: E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, the bellman ford

algorithm returns a boolean value indicating whether or not a negative-weight cycle that is reachable from the source.

$\Rightarrow$ If there is such a cycle, the algorithm indicates no solution exists.

if there is no such a cycle, the algorithm produces the shortest paths and their weights.

$\Rightarrow$ This algorithm returns True iff the graph contains no negative weight cycles that are reachable from the source.

BELLMAN-FORD(G, s)

Initialize-Single-Source(G, s)

for $i = 1$ to $|G.V| - 1$ — $O(V)$

for each edge $(u, v) \in G.E$
Relax(u, v, w)

for each edge $(u, v) \in G.E$ — $O(E)$

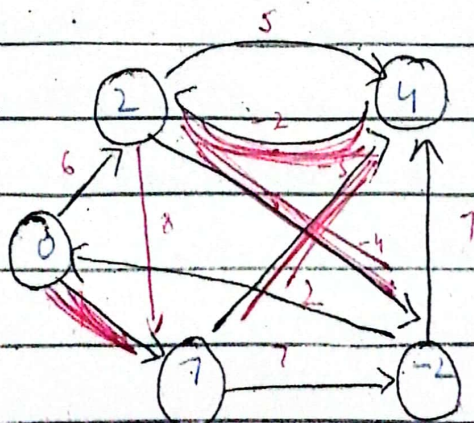
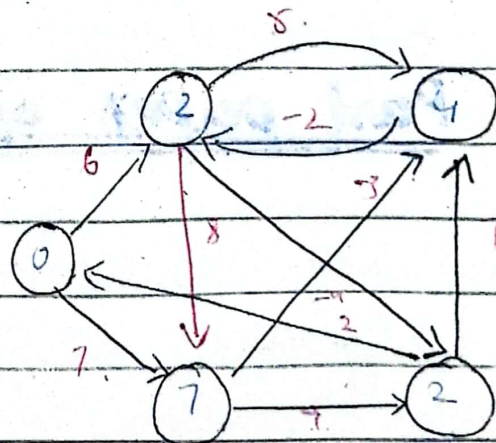
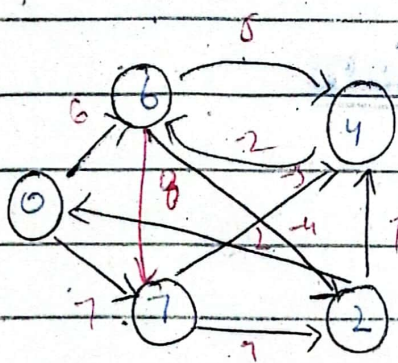
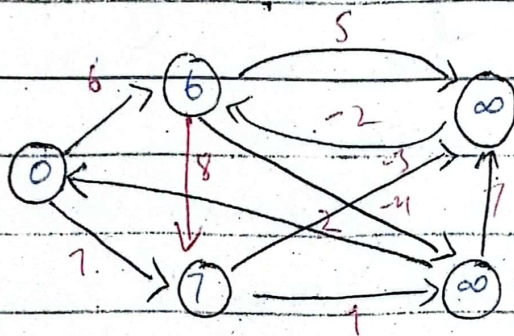
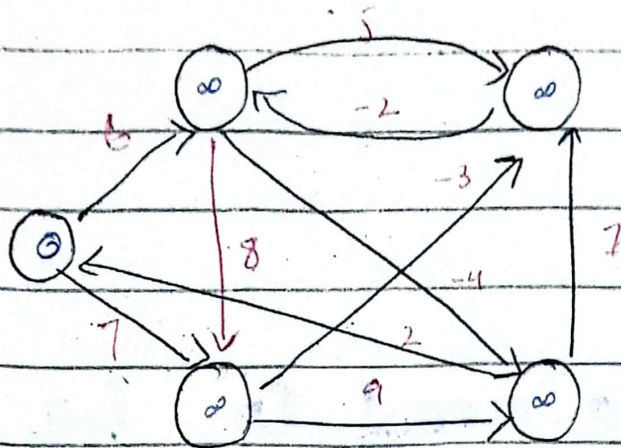
if $v.d > u.d + w(u, v)$
return FALSE

return TRUE

Time complexity $O(V \cdot E)$

Space complexity $O(M)$

- Note: Loop will execute no of vertices - 1.



Node	d	π	
s	$\infty / 0$	NILL	
t	$\infty / 6 / 2$	NILL / s / x	
x	$\infty / 11 / 4$	NILL / t / y	Return true.
y	$\infty / 7$	NILL / s	
z	$\infty / 2 / -2$	NILL / t / t	

Why do we need to be careful with negative weights?

$\Rightarrow$ Negative weight edge can create negative weight cycles.

$\Rightarrow$ Negative weight cycles can give incorrect result when trying to find out the shortest path.

Past paper questions

1) what is the purpose of Dijkstra's algorithm?

2) Briefly describe the bellman-ford algorithm.

3) what is the major difference b/w bellman-ford & dijkstra's algorithm?

4) why dijkstra's does not work with negative weight cycle?